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Gröbner Bases and Elimination in Macaulay 2

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Abstract

This thesis covers fundamental concepts in algebraic geometry, polynomial elimination and Gröbner bases. It accomplishes this by introducing affine spaces and varieties to allow a better understanding of what algebraic geometry is, and then pivots to exploring Gröbner bases. This is done with the final goal of constructing an algorithm that can compute these bases deterministically. First, monomial ideals are considered and then the scope is extended to polynomial ideals. A verification of membership to Gröbner bases, the Buchberger criterion, is proven. The Buchberger algorithm, or the construction of Gröbner basis, is implemented in the computer algebra system Macaulay2 using the criterion. Univariate division, multivariate division, and solutions to systems of polynomial equations were also implemented algorithmically. The algorithms were verified programmatically with unit tests. The thesis provides an interesting introduction to the construction and implementation of algorithms as well as a solid foundation for future expansion into algebraic geometry or algorithms construction.

Abstract

Denna kandidatuppsats inriktar sig mot grundläggande koncept inom algebraisk geometri, eliminering av polynoma system samt Gröbner baser. Algebraisk geometri snuddades vid genom att introducera affina rum och varieteter och hoppar sedan vidare till algebra genom att utforska Gröbner baser. Utforskningen av dessa baser utförs med konstruktionen av en algoritm som kan beräkna en Gröbner bas som slutmål. För att uppnå detta diskuteras monomialideal och polynomideal samt användbara egenskaper. Därefter bevisas den grundläggande kärnan till Gröbner bas algoritmen, Buchberger kriterium. Detta kriterium används för att programmera Buchbergers algoritm, alltså skapandet av en Gröbner bas, i datorsalgebrapråket Macaulay2. Envariabel och flervariabel polynomdivision samt lösningar till polynoma system implementerades också i Macaulay2. Resultaten verifierades med enhetstester. Uppsatsen lägger en stark grund till framtida utforskning av algebraisk geometri och algoritmkonstruktion.

Contents

1	Introduction	8
2	The Algebraic Abstraction of Geometry	9
2.1	Polynomials	9
2.2	Affine Spaces and Varieties	10
2.2.1	Affine Spaces	10
2.2.2	Polynomials in Affine Spaces	12
2.2.3	Affine Varieties	12
3	Algebra Theory	14
3.1	Rings and Ideals	14
3.1.1	Monomial Ideals	14
3.1.2	Dicksons Lemma	15
3.2	Hilbert Bases Theorem	16
3.3	Gröbner Bases	17
3.3.1	Properties Of Gröbner Bases	18
3.3.2	Buchberger's Criterion	18
4	Algorithms in Macaulay2	22
4.1	Division Algorithms	22
4.1.1	Univariate Division Algorithm	22
4.1.2	Multivariate Division Algorithm	23
4.2	The Buchberger Algorithm	24
4.3	Solving Systems of Polynomials	26
4.3.1	Book Examples of Polynomial Solutions	26
4.3.2	Solving a System of Polynomial Equations	27
5	Discussion	29
5.1	Mathematical Proof and Knowledge	29
5.2	Algorithm Implementation	29
A	Macaulay2 source files	31
A.1	Algorithms	31
A.2	Examples	40
	References	45

1 Introduction

This bachelors thesis is centered around the intersection between theoretical mathematics and practical computer science: algorithms. Algorithms stand with one foot in each domain, and both are equally important. In order to begin instructing a computer on how to solve a problem, a clear idea of the problem as well as a concrete way to solve it must be established. This is the theoretical aspect of algorithmic construction and is agnostic of any computer implementation. Proving that a result is unique, or verifying that an algorithm terminates are critical aspects of success. The theoretical is not enough and one cannot avoid dirtying ones hands forever. The implementation is equally necessary. These algorithms are created to solve practical problems, and a way to use them is necessary.

The gap between the theoretical and practical is never easy to bridge. Especially since they both present unique challenges. The main algorithm being studied in this thesis is the construction of Gröbner bases. These bases are computationally useful and can be applied to optimizing the movement of robotic arms [LM21]. As such, finding an algorithm that always yields a Gröbner basis and terminates after a finite number of steps is of interest. The steps taken to prove the algorithm theoretically were inspired by [DAC10]. After an understanding of the theory was present, the computer algebra system (CAS) Macaulay2 [GS] was leveraged to implement the algorithm.

Division and polynomial elimination algorithms tackled through a different lens. Instead of standing in the middle, a step closer to the computer was taken. The thesis explores the process of receiving a proven algorithm and implementing it. The theory behind division algorithms is well known, and implementing them provided sufficient resistance when acclimating to a new computer language. When writing the division algorithms, the challenges were syntactical or a general lack of knowledge surrounding how a CAS works. The algorithms themselves are straightforward from a mathematical implementation view, but they were a necessary step to get accustomed with Macaulay2, these algorithms provided little mathematical insight. The implementation of the polynomial elimination provided a much needed step back towards the mathematical domain. Here, solid mathematical knowledge was necessary in order to inform the computer what had to be done. The pseudocode presented was more fluid and allowed for implementational flexibility. While this was an immense challenge, it was completed successfully.

2 The Algebraic Abstraction of Geometry

Algebra can be seen as the mathematical expression of the human need for structure and abstraction. Through algebra, humans try to capture more of the mathematical, and natural, domain under their pen. The endless hunger for knowledge can express itself in various way. When using algebra as a tool, creating abstract models that capture generic structure is favored. However, these abstract models can be difficult to understand. The ability to navigate between levels of abstraction is a vital tool for any mathematician interested in applying algebraic methods.

This paper assumes a degree of familiarity with algebraic structures, but the uninitiated peruser is kindly directed towards the digestable "Introduction to Modern Algebra" [Wei70] with guiding exercises, or alternatively, the more rigorous "Abstract Algebra" [DF03] for a deeper understanding.

As the section header suggests, this section will be primarily focused with defining the tools necessary to build an analytic bridge between geometry and algebra so that we can analyze geometric objects through algebra. A function that maps geometric objects to algebraic must be established. This function uses Affine Varieties and Ideals, along with the dictionary established in the Hilbert Strong Nullstellensatz, to accomplish that goal.

2.1 Polynomials

In order to discuss mathematical concepts, a compact object is required. This is done by compressing information into a single mathematical expression. In order to discuss polynomials rings, we begin with defining least compressed case, monomials. Then, we consider a collection of monomials, a polynomial. Finally, we can consider the compact object, polynomial rings.

Definition 2.1. A **monomial** in $x_1, \dots, x_n$ is a product of the form

$$x^\alpha = x_1^{\alpha_1} \cdot x_2^{\alpha_2} \cdots x_n^{\alpha_n}$$

where all $\alpha = \alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_n$ are nonnegative integers.

As the root prefix "mono" suggests, there is only one of these terms x^α . They are independent and self-contained. However, as we are creating the tools to generalize and deal with more abstract concepts, we also want to include the ability to capture any linear combination of these monomials.

Definition 2.2. A **polynomial** f in $x_1, \dots, x_n$ with coefficients, $a_1, \dots, a_n$, in a field k is a finite linear combination of monomials.

$$f = \sum_{\alpha} a_{\alpha} x^{\alpha}, \quad a_{\alpha} \in k$$

With the polynomial definitions at hand, we can construct the final abstraction for our mathematics involving polynomials, the polynomial ring. This is defined as $k[x_1, \dots, x_n]$. When leveraging this powerful abstraction, we capture n dimensions of variables on any field k . This achieves the goal of compact analysis.

2.2 Affine Spaces and Varieties

For the purpose of this thesis, geometry will be restricted to how points, lines, planes (and higher dimensional objects) interact with space. To build a bridge between algebra and geometry, there must be an established way to discuss geometry algebraically. This is where the concepts of affine spaces comes in.

2.2.1 Affine Spaces

Let us take a moment to reflect around how one might represent a geometric object. Consider a line. One could use the well known two dimensional cartesian plane, plot the points $(x_1, y_1), (x_2, y_2)$ and then pull a pen between the two points. Here, a line as been created, but it is dependent on the following: a coordinate system and a restriction of dimension so we can physically represent it. These restrictions are undesirable when studying a line algebraically, so we must circumvent these restrictions. The solution is affine spaces. Affine spaces are coordinate-agnostic spaces. This eliminates our need for the coordinate system that was a prerequisite when drawing the lines, which is a good start. The affine space is also easily extended beyond the physical.

Definition 2.3. An *affine space* is either the empty set, or a triple $\langle E, \vec{E}, + \rangle$. E is a nonempty set of points while $\vec{E}$ is a vector space (of translations). The action $+$ is an operation on both E and $\vec{E}$ defined as follows: $+: E \times \vec{E} \rightarrow E$. The following axioms are assumed for affine space:

1. $a + 0 = a$ for every $a \in E$.
2. $(a + u) + v = a + (u + v)$ for every $a \in E$ and every $u, v \in \vec{E}$.

3. For any two points $a, b \in E$, there is a unique $u \in \vec{E}$ such that $a + u = b$

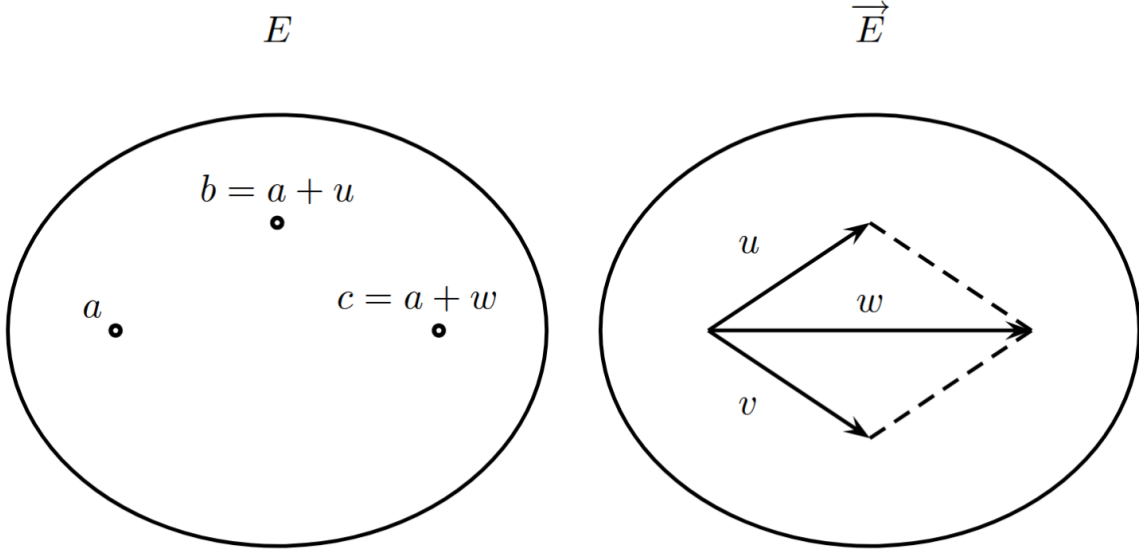


Figure 1: Intuitive understanding of affine space [Gal25]

A quick note of importance on each axiom. If you start at point a and do nothing, you should still be at a . Axiom two deals with the associative property. The ability to rearrange calculations simplifies any algebra involved. The last axiom, that of uniqueness is computationally useful. Assuming that an unique element in $\vec{E}$ always exists that can connect two points a and b is useful when solving these problems on a higher level of abstraction, especially when a computer that cannot handle errors is involved.

The intuition behind the coordinate-agnostic nature should be clear when considering figure 1. Here a separation between the vectors and the points *to which the vector is applied to* should be noted. These two can be defined independently and therefore there is no system tying them together. An example is provided for further clarity.

Example 2.4. Given a field k and a positive integer n , define the n -dimensional *affine space* over k as:

$$k^n := \langle \{[\hat{x}_1, \dots, \hat{x}_n]^T : \hat{x}_i \in k, i = 1, \dots, n\}, \vec{k}^n, + \rangle$$

Where $\vec{k}^n$ is the vector space of translations, and $+$ denotes the action of shifting a point by a vector via component-wise addition.

To further our understanding of the space, we can use the concrete example where the field in question is $\mathbb{R}$. Then, we get the familiar space $\mathbb{R}^n$. So the affine space is more abstract than the one we are used to dealing with from real world applications where we are restricted.

2.2.2 Polynomials in Affine Spaces

With a better understanding of affine spaces, we will consider how polynomials relate to this space. Using the definition 2.2 we define the polynomial *function* $p \in k[x_1, \dots, x_n]$ as follows:

$$p : k^n \rightarrow k$$

The function maps the multidimensional field onto the single dimension. This p takes every $x_1, \dots, x_n$ and replaces it with $a_1, \dots, a_n \in k[x_1, \dots, x_n]$. This is done easily by substituting every $x_i = a_i$ in the polynomial p . Since all the substituted a 's are elements $k[x_1, \dots, x_n]$, then $p(a_1, \dots, a_n)$ is also in $k[x_1, \dots, x_n]$.

2.2.3 Affine Varieties

With an understanding of how the space we will operate upon will work and how the polynomials can be evaluated on that space, the first algebraic structure of geometry will be discussed: affine varieties.

Definition 2.5. Let k be a field, and let $f_1, \dots, f_s$ be polynomials in $k[x_1, \dots, x_n]$. Then, set

$$\mathbf{V}(f_1, \dots, f_s) = \{(a_1, \dots, a_n) \in k^n \mid f_i(a_1, \dots, a_n) = 0 \ \forall 1 \leq i \leq s\}$$

We call $\mathbf{V}(f_1, \dots, f_s)$ the **affine variety** defined by $f_1, \dots, f_s$.

In other words, the affine variety is the set of $(a_1, \dots, a_n)$ that solve all the equations defined in the variety simultaneously. Or, it is the intersection of all the polynomial roots. Even though $\mathbf{V}$ might simply look like a graphed equation, figure 2a only provides the *base* for intuition. While it may look like a regular circular graph, with familiar x and y coordinates, the keen observer will note that we are dealing with two dimensions, x_1, x_2 and that the graph is in fact the where this polynomial studied is equal to 0. If we extract the polynomial from the variety and set it to 0, we end up with $x_1^2 + x_2^2 = 1$. Figures 2b and 2c show the increasing

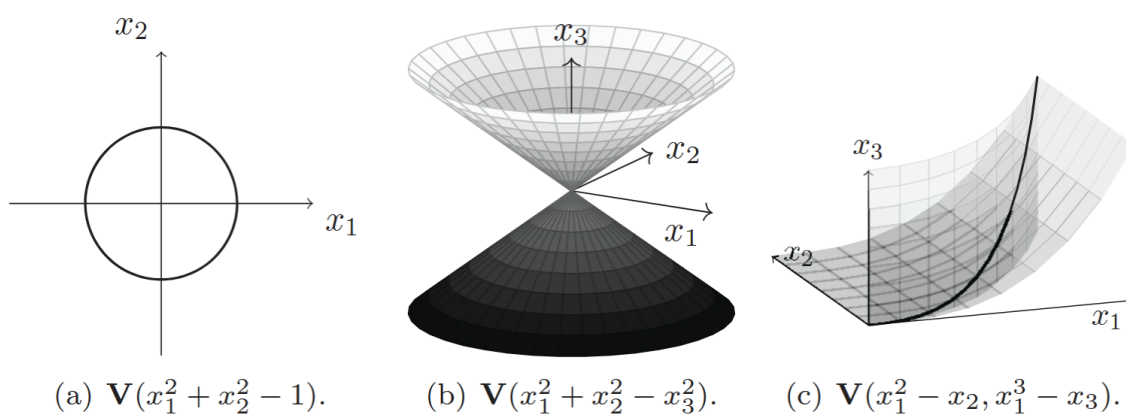


Figure 2: Examples of affine spaces [LM21]

complexity in three dimensions. Graphing this equation makes the roots of the polynomial self-evident, but graphing it is neither necessary or desirable. It is only a tool to inform intuition. This is especially true as we are interested in n dimensions and graphing will become next to impossible.

3 Algebra Theory

With affine varieties under our belt, there is an obvious follow up to this knowledge, especially for those interested in the real application of this mathematics. Namely, how do we solve these varieties? Luckily, the problem of asking for the affine variety points can be reduced to solving a system of polynomials equations. This is easier said than done, and computational complexity arises when considering n dimensions. Most real world problems will involve many dimensions, and being able to solve these problems quickly and with confidence is of importance. To do so, utilizing a computer algorithm would be a solution.

Every computer language has important data structures that determine how the language is shaped. For Macaulay 2, ideals is one of these types. They are important to algebra, and native support for manipulating ideals exist. However, to efficiently handle ideals, there is a problem that needs to be solved with great confidence. Namely: how do we go between abstract entities such as ideals and something that a computer can interact with?

3.1 Rings and Ideals

The ideal description problem formulates the bridge between the abstract and machine world. It does this by concretizing the abstract concept of an ideal to a tangible set of generating polynomials that can be interacted with and evaluated. In order to bridge this gap, finite polynomial ideals have to be found. Starting by analyzing monomial ideals in $k[x_1, \dots, x_n]$ is the first step.

3.1.1 Monomial Ideals

Much like when introducing affine varieties, starting with a single monomial instead of the combination of them reduces complexity. So, when studying the ideals, we start by considering a less complex problem.

Definition 3.1. An ideal $I \subseteq k[x_1, \dots, x_n]$ is a monomial ideal that is determined by a set $A \subset \mathbb{Z}^n$. All polynomials in the ideal can be written as a linear combination of $\sum_{\alpha \in A} h_{\alpha} x^{\alpha}$ where h_{α} lies in $k[x_1, \dots, x_n]$.

Monomial ideals can largely be thought of as their exponents. This is their main benefit and why they are important when dealing with computer algebra systems.

We will see this property in the coming proofs. As an example, consider the following lemma:

Lemma 3.2. *Let $I = \langle x^\alpha | \alpha \in A \rangle$ be a monomial ideal. Then a monomial x^β lies in I if and only if x^β is divisible by x^α for some $\alpha \in A$.*

Proof. $\Leftarrow$ This can be proven by considering the exponents. Starting off with showing x^β to x^α , the exponents can be leveraged. If β is a multiple of α then x^β is in the ideal by definition since x^α generates the ideal.

$\Rightarrow$ Using the definition of the monomial ideal, we can write x^β as the polynomial sum of generators of the monomial ideal and then write h_i as the sum of generators again.

$$x^\beta = \sum_{i=1}^s h_i x^{\alpha(i)} = \sum_{i=1}^s \left(\sum_j c_{i,j} x^{\beta(i,j)} \right) x^{\alpha(i)} = \sum_{i,j} c_{i,j} x^{\beta(i,j)} x^{\alpha(i)}$$

Here we can see that every term on the right hand side is divisible by x^α , so then x^β on the left hand side must also be so. This proves that we can follow our intuition regarding the exponents and their divisibility. □

3.1.2 Dicksons Lemma

This lemma demonstrates the usefulness of monomial ideals. The ability to reduce ideals to finite generators is a step towards closing the gap between the machine and abstract.

Theorem 3.3. *Let $I = \langle x^\alpha | \alpha \in A \rangle$ be a monomial ideal. Then I can be finitely written by $I = \langle x^{\alpha(1)}, \dots, x^{\alpha(s)} \rangle$, where all α lie in A .*

Proof. Consider an inductive approach. Starting off with $n = 1$ for our $k[x_1, \dots, x_n]$, it is easy to see that the smallest element of $A \subseteq \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}$ generates the remaining elements. With $n > 1$, we start our induction. Consider the n th case. We have the monomial ideal, call it J , from the $n - 1$ case. This is finite by our induction, so when our A goes from a subset of $\mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}^{n-1}$ to $\mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}^n$, we can generate slices of these J ideals with the new $x_n = y$ variable. We take some sufficiently large $m \geq 0$ and group the J_l ideals by their corresponding y value up to $m - 1$. In other words, let the ideal J_l be generated by x^β where $x^\beta y^l \in I$. These J_l slices form a topological map of the ideal I . Thus, I is also finite. □

After a finite ideal is generated, the monomial ideal membership problem is solved. This is since we can take a polynomial and check if the remainder from division by the finite monomial ideal is 0. If it is, it belongs to the monomial ideal since one of the members will generate it.

3.2 Hilbert Bases Theorem

In this section, the result that monomial ideals have finite generators is extended to polynomial ideals. The basic idea is that by rearranging the ideal to a monomial ideal using the leading term, we can apply the Dicksons lemma. The first step towards bridging the gap between polynomial and monomial ideals is by crafting an ideal of interest. Namely, the ideal generated by the leading term of a polynomial ideal.

Definition 3.4. Let $I \subseteq k[x_1, \dots, x_n]$ be an ideal other than $\{0\}$ and fix a monomial ordering. Then

1. $LT(I) = \{cx^\alpha \mid \text{there exists } f \in I \setminus \{0\} \text{ with } LT(f) = cx^\alpha\}.$
2. $\langle LT(I) \rangle$ is the ideal generated by the elements of $LT(I)$.

$LT(I)$ is a large set, but it is the bridge between general ideals and monomial ideals. After all, the difference between a monomial and the lead term of the polynomial are the other monomials in the polynomial. If we can capture them by constructing an ideal that generates everything by using the leading term, we can create a superset to operate upon. $\langle LT(I) \rangle$ is that set.

Proposition 3.5. Let $I \subseteq k[x_1, \dots, x_n]$ be an ideal different from the $\{0\}$.

1. $\langle LT(I) \rangle$ is a monomial ideal.
2. There are $g_1, \dots, g_t \in I$ such that $\langle LT(I) \rangle = \langle LT(g_1), \dots, LT(g_t) \rangle$.

Proof. Since we have used the leading term to construct an ideal, the difference between the monomial ideal and $\langle LT(I) \rangle$ is a nonzero constant. Consider a single $g_i = g$, and break the lead term down to the lead coefficient and lead monomial. $LT(g) = LC(g) \cdot LM(g)$ means that $LT(g)$ is a field scalar of $LM(g)$, which means that $LT(g) \in \langle LM(g) \rangle$. We can multiply by the inverse to show that $LT(g) \cdot LC^{-1}(g) = LM(g)$. But $LC^{-1}(g)$ is still in $k[x_1, \dots, x_n]$, so the same logic applied and they are equal to each other. So, $\langle LT(I) \rangle = \langle LM(I) \rangle$. The same logic is used

for the second item. Using Dicksons Lemma tells us that monomial ideals are finitely generated. Since $\langle LT(I) \rangle$ only differs from a monomial ideal by a nonzero constant, Dicksons lemma can be applied here as well and I is finitely generated. $\square$

With all this information accumulated, we can formally prove that every polynomial ideal has a finite generating set. This theorem is known as the Hilbert Basis Theorem.

Theorem 3.6 (Hilbert Bases Theorem). *Every ideal $I \in k[x_1, \dots, x_n]$ has a finite generating set. In other words, $I = \langle g_1, \dots, g_t \rangle$ for some $g_1, \dots, g_t \in I$.*

This proof is outside of the scope, but is given in chapter 2 of Cox [DAC10] as Theorem 4 on page 77.

3.3 Gröbner Bases

The generating set $\langle LT(I) \rangle$ was introduced in the last section. Dealing with monomials reduces the complexity drastically as opposed to polynomials, so if we can use the $\langle LT(I) \rangle$ instead of the polynomial one, it would simplify calculations. Recall that the Hilbert basis theorem stated that every polynomial ideal has a finite generating set. However, it is not unique. We will start with an ideal that is of special interest to the world of polynomial calculation.

Definition 3.7. Choose a monomial ordering on the polynomial ring $k[x_1, \dots, x_n]$. A finite nonzero subset, $G = \{g_1, \dots, g_t\}$ of an ideal, I , which is a subset of $polyRing$ is a **Gröbner basis** if

$$\langle LT(g_1), \dots, LT(g_t) \rangle = \langle LT(I) \rangle \quad (1)$$

The construction is purposeful; we can operate on a object of immense size, $\langle LT(I) \rangle$, while restricting ourselves to a finite number of generators. This makes the theoretical exploration less complex due to the flexibility of $\langle LT(I) \rangle$. It also ensures that giving instruction to a computer becomes possible as we have eliminated the need to find an infinite ideal. Instead, we find the finite generating set.

The next question to answer is how to construct Gröbner bases to operate upon. Since these are useful for computational purposes, an algorithm for how to compute them will be discussed and proven. Before that, it is important to have an understanding of some key properties we can leverage from this basis.

3.3.1 Properties Of Gröbner Bases

The order of the dividing polynomials affects the outcome when performing multivariate division. This is problematic when establishing deterministic outcomes. By fixing a lexicographical order, Gröbner bases guarantee a unique remainder.

Proposition 3.8. *Let $I \subseteq k[x_1, \dots, x_n]$ be an ideal and let $G = \{g_1, \dots, g_t\}$ be a Gröbner basis for I . Then given $f \in k[x_1, \dots, x_n]$, there is a unique $r \in k[x_1, \dots, x_n]$ with the two following properties:*

1. *No term of r is divisible by any of $LT(g_1), \dots, LT(g_t)$.*
2. *There is a $g \in I$ such that $f = g + r$.*

Proof. Consider the division algorithm $f = q_1g_1 \cdots + q_tg_t + r$. Every $LT(g_t)$ is already divided out. In other words, if r had been divisible by the lead term there would have been a corresponding q_t to engulf it. That proves (1). (2) is solved by considering the fact that we are operating with Gröbner bases; we must leverage our ability to show that $\langle LT(I) \rangle = \langle LT(g_1), \dots, LT(g_t) \rangle$. To prove uniqueness, assume that the remainder is non-unique and use lemma 3.2 to disprove that assumption. In other words: assume that $f = g + r = g' + r'$ follows our proposition. Rearranging, $r - r' = g - g' \in I$. Now, using the special property of the basis, $LT(r - r') \in \langle LT(I) \rangle = \langle LT(g_1), \dots, LT(g_t) \rangle$. Since $LT(r - r')$ is on $LT(g_i)$, then it is also divisible by that same $LT(g_i)$. Using the first property, $r - r'$ cannot be divided by $LT(g_i)$, so in order for the division to succeed, $r - r' = 0$. This contradicts the assumption that r was non-unique. $\square$

Another important property is how easily one can verify if a function is in an ideal. The membership problem is solved by dividing f by G and checking if the remainder is zero. If it is, then the function belongs to the ideal. This membership check's concrete nature is useful for computational applications.

3.3.2 Buchberger's Criterion

The following definitions and lemmas are preparatory for algorithmically finding Gröbner bases. The algorithm and my implementation using Macaulay2 can be found in section 4.2.

Definition 3.9. We will write $\overline{f}^F$ for the remainder on division of f by the ordered s-tuple $F = (f_1, \dots, f_s)$. If F is a Gröbner basis for $\langle f_1, \dots, f_s \rangle$, then we can regard F as a set.

Now that we have a concise way to refer to the remainder of a division by two arbitrary parameters, our dialog around the subject will be less cluttered. A deterministic approach to cancelling leading terms would help in the construction of our algorithm. Below is a definition that introduces the tool we will use to craft the algorithm's kernel.

Definition 3.10. Let $f, g \in k[x_1, \dots, x_n]$ be nonzero polynomials.

1. If $\text{multideg}(f) = \alpha$ and $\text{multideg}(g) = \beta$, then let $\gamma = (\gamma_1, \dots, \gamma_n)$, where $\gamma_i = \max(\alpha_i, \beta_i)$ for each i . We call x^γ the least common multiple of $LM(f)$ and $LM(g)$, written $x^\gamma = \text{lcm}(LM(f), LM(g))$.
2. The S-polynomial of f and g is the combination

$$S(f, g) = \frac{x^\gamma}{LT(f)} \cdot f - \frac{x^\gamma}{LT(g)} \cdot g \quad (2)$$

Let us explore the definition provided by the book [DAC10]. Our numerators share the extracted least common multiple. The other interesting part is that the incoming parameterized functions, f, g , are being divided by their own leading term. It seems as if though the least common multiple ensures that a cancellation occurs. In other words, this S-polynomial could be an engine for reducing the degree of polynomials. The next lemma showcases an exiting part of mathematics. Namely, validating intuition.

Lemma 3.11. *Suppose we have a sum $\sum_{i=1}^s p_i$ where $\text{multideg}(p_i) = \delta \in \mathbb{Z}_n^{\geq 0}$ for all i . If $\text{multdeg}(\sum_{i=1}^s p_i) < \delta$, then $\sum_{i=1}^s p_i$ is a linear combination with coefficients in k , of the S-polynomials $S(p_j, p_l)$ for $i \leq j, l \leq s$. Furthermore, each $S(p_j, p_l)$ has $\text{multidegree} < \delta$.*

Cox and his book [DAC10] turns our attention to an interesting idea. The assumption made in the lemma relies heavily on the properties of the s-polynomial. The written proof exists in the book in chapter 2.6 as Lemma 5. The intuition to extract from the proof can be described as follows.

Consider an addition of polynomials, all of them equal in multidegree, summing to a lesser multidegree. If you can find an example of that, this lemma ensures that you can rewrite that addition of polynomials as an addition of s-polynomials. Using this fact, the criteria for admission into the gröbner basis can be created.

Theorem 3.12 (Buchberger's Criterion). *Let I be a polynomial ideal. Then a basis $G = g_1, \dots, g_t$ of I is a Gröbner basis of I if and only if the remainder of the S-polynomial constructed using g_i, g_j ($i \neq j$) by G is zero. Or in other words if: $\overline{S(g_i, g_j)}^G = 0$ for all $(g_i, g_j) \in G$ where $(i \neq j)$.*

Here, the idea behind finding Gröbner bases is shown. All one has to do to find a Gröbner basis is to simply check all the g_t s against each other using the constructed S-polynomial. If a nonzero remainder is found, a new g_{t+1} is added to the basis being generated. If the remainder is zero, then we are positive that we have a Gröbner basis.

Proof. $\Rightarrow$ If G is a Gröbner basis, then we are trying to prove the remainder $\overline{S(g_i, g_j)}^G$ is 0. Leveraging the problem of membership, we can recall that the remainder would be 0 for all members of the Gröbner basis. Since all of the S-polynomials are on I , the remainder is 0.

$\Leftarrow$ We start by letting $f \in I$ be nonzero. Prove that

$$LT(f) \in \langle LT(g_1), \dots, LT(g_n) \rangle$$

This is done by considering the following functions:

$$f = \sum_{i=1}^t h_i g_i, h_i \in k[x_1, \dots, x_n] \quad (3)$$

$$\text{multdeg}(f) \leq \max \{ \text{multdeg}(h_i g_i) \mid h_i g_i \neq 0 \} \quad (4)$$

$$\delta = \max_{1 \leq i \leq t} \{ \text{multdeg}(h_i g_i) \} \quad (5)$$

By equations 4 and 5 we can arrive at the fact $\text{multdeg}(f) \leq \delta$. In addition to this, we will also minimize the δ . Since we have that $\text{multdeg}(f) \leq \delta = \min \text{multdeg}(f)$, there needs to be two separate cases.

1. $\text{multdeg}(f) = \delta$. Then, $LT(f)$ is divisible by $LT(g_i)$ since the gröbner base produces all leading terms in the ideal. In other words:

$$LT(f) \in \langle LT(g_1), \dots, LT(g_n) \rangle$$

2. $\text{multdeg}(f) < \delta$.

Proving $\text{multdeg}(f) < \delta$ requires rigor. Lets us first state an assumption which we will operate upon: The arrangment of f provides a minimal δ cannot be reduced further. If that assumption can be broken by finding a smaller δ , then we have proven that δ will always be the $\text{multdeg}(f) = \delta$ case.

We do this by considering an f with a minimum δ . Split the sum into its two components and then extract the leading term for each iteration of i .

$$\begin{aligned} f &= \sum_{\text{multdeg}(h_i g_i) = \delta} h_i g_i + \sum_{\text{multdeg}(h_i g_i) < \delta} h_i g_i \\ &= \sum_{\text{multdeg}(h_i g_i) = \delta} LT(h_i) g_i + \sum_{\text{multdeg}(h_i g_i) = \delta} (h_i - LT(h_i)) g_i + \sum_{\text{multdeg}(h_i g_i) < \delta} h_i g_i \end{aligned} \quad (6)$$

Clearly the sum of functions with multidegree less than δ cannot sum to something greater than δ . Equally so, the degree of the sum of functions where a leading term has been removed will be lesser than the multidegree the functions to begin with. So the second and third sums of the expanded equation 6 will be less than δ . So, we can focus our attention solely on the monomials of the sum that includes the leading term. This is since if we can prove that the monomials in the sum of the leading terms is less than δ , then the claim of δ minimal property is contradicted. This is where our well studied S-polynomial is used.

Since the sum of all the sums in equation 6 is less than δ , our leading term sum is forced to be less than δ . But this was the exact definition from lemma 3.11. So we can rewrite the sum of leading terms as a combination of S-polynomials. But the consequence of using S-polynomials and lemma 3.11 was precisely that the summands have a lesser multidegree. Then, we have shown that f can be rewritten as a sum of polynomials, all with multidegree less than that minimal δ . Thus, we have contridicted the initial claim.

□

This criterion is the primary tool for the algorithm that is going to be constructed and programmed. By having a concrete way of checking if a function is part of a Gröbner bases, an algorithm can be constructed.

4 Algorithms in Macaulay2

One of the books I was reading [LM21] has an introductory section to Macaulay2, so to familiarize myself with the language, I read and recreated given examples. These can be found in the appendix A.2 or at the GitHub link [Eri26]. These examples were solid introductions to important concepts such as how to create an ideal or Gröbner bases but were also helpful to familiarize myself with the syntax of the language. However, in order to properly use the language, the next step was to implement an algorithm.

4.1 Division Algorithms

Division algorithms have been of interest for mathematicians for a long time. Basic arithmetic with additions, subtraction, and multiplication can be constrained to $\mathbb{Z}$, the integers, while the introduction of division necessitates an entirely different way of interacting with numbers, $\mathbb{Q}$, the rationals. Division is useful, so a mathematical programming language must be equipped with ways to handle division. Macaulay2 has various ways of dividing, and actually offers built in support for polynomial division. However, the division algorithm seemed like a fitting first challenge. Attempting to extend it to divide polynomials left me with a multitude of problems, highlighting how exercises are the best way to learn a new subject in mathematics.

4.1.1 Univariate Division Algorithm

Algorithm 1 Univariate Division Algorithm

Require: Functions p, g

Ensure: Quotient q and remainder r

```
1:  $r \leftarrow p$ 
2:  $q \leftarrow 0$ 
3: while  $r \neq 0$  AND  $\deg(r) \geq \deg(g)$  do
4:    $t \leftarrow \text{LT}(r) / \text{LT}(g)$ 
5:    $q \leftarrow q + t$ 
6:    $r \leftarrow r - gt$ 
7: end while
8: return  $(q, r)$ 
```

The first algorithm I tried writing was the univariate polynomial division, see code in listing 1. The algorithm is straight forward: take the leading term of the

numerator and divide it by the denominator. Add the quotient to the result and subtract the quotient times the denominator from the numerator. Repeat until the terminate condition is hit: either the numerator is zero, and there is nothing to divide, or the degree of the denominator exceeds that of the numerator, and division is not possible. Theoretically and practically, it was simple.

4.1.2 Multivariate Division Algorithm

The idea behind the multivariate division algorithm is similar to the univariate one. Divide a polynomial p by an array of polynomials $g_1, \dots, g_s$. If the leading term of p cannot be divided by the leading term of g_1 , move on to the next until a g_i that can divide p is found. If no leading term of $g_1, \dots, g_s$ can divide the leading term of p , then the leading term p is subtracted from itself and the algorithm marches to the next polynomial.

Algorithm 2 Multivariate Division Algorithm

Require: Functions $p, g_1, \dots, g_n$

Ensure: Quotients q_s and remainder r

```

1:  $r \leftarrow 0$ 
2:  $f \leftarrow p$ 
3:  $q_s \leftarrow$ 
4: while  $f \neq 0$  do
5:    $i \leftarrow 0$ 
6:   divisionOccurred  $\leftarrow$  false
7:   while  $i \leq n$  AND divisionOccurred = false do
8:     if  $\text{LM}(f) \mid \text{LM}(g_i) = 0$  then
9:        $t \leftarrow f/g_i$ 
10:       $q_i \leftarrow q_i + t$ 
11:       $f \leftarrow f - g_i t$ 
12:      divisionOccurred = true
13:     else
14:        $i \leftarrow i + 1$ 
15:     end if
16:   end while
17:   if divisionOccurred = false then
18:      $r \leftarrow r + \text{LT}(f)$ 
19:      $f \leftarrow f - \text{LT}(f)$ 
20:   end if
21: end while
22: return  $(q_s, r)$ 

```

While theoretically simple again, implementational complexity exists. One such complexity arises from ring division. With the addition of the higher dimension, the regular division was giving fractions of rings. This is problematic as the return (q_s, r) need to be members of the same ring as p . To solve this, a function that decomposed the polynomials into lists of monomials, coefficients, and exponents was created. The function would generate a list of the exponents taking the ring elements into account. So, as an example, if the ring is $\mathbb{Q}[x, y, z]$, the polynomial $x^2 * z$ would be decomposed into $\{2, 0, 1\}$. By creating these lists and subtracting the exponents from each other, monomial division has occurred. All remaining would be to recreate the polynomial using the generators of the ring and raise them to the exponent in the listed order. Here my lacking understanding of Macaulay2, and more generally ring algebra, is evident. The generators of the ring, and the ring itself are different. In my implementation (listing 2) the line 63 states the following: `toList gens ring p`. Here, we find the ring of polynomials p , find the generators of the ring, and then create a list of them. When reapplying the exponential list to the generators, any reference to the ring itself is lost. The list of generators is simply a list, decoupled from the ring by stateless design.

Instead of recreating a way to divide monomials or using fractions of rings, Macaulay2 supports division that ensures the result remains in the ring. Thus, the algorithm was ready to be implemented. By first checking if the modulo between the lead monomial of p and g_i would be 0, we can ensure that the ring division would succeed.

4.2 The Buchberger Algorithm

Buchbergers Algorithm is the algorithm that finds a complete gröbner basis. The Buchberger criterion so carefully proven in the previous sections of this thesis is fully leveraged here. In doing so, the algorithm itself is rather easy to implement as all the work behind the algorithm is in proving that the criterion is sufficient to generate the Gröbner basis. All one has to do is take the functions $p_1, \dots, p_n$, create the pairs for all of them, generate the S-polynomial for each, and perform the subsequent multivariate polynomial division.

Proof. There are two parts to the proof. First, we must prove that the generated set, G , actually is a Gröbner basis, and then we must prove that the algorithm terminates. We can prove that G is a Gröbner basis by first noting that that $G \subseteq I$

Algorithm 3 Buchberger Algorithm

Require: Functions $P = p_1, \dots, p_n$ that generate I .

Ensure: A Gröbner basis $G = g_1, \dots, g_s$ for I , with $P \subseteq G$

```
1:  $G \leftarrow P$ 
2:  $\hat{G} \leftarrow \{\}$ 
3: while  $G \neq \hat{G}$  do
4:    $\hat{G} \leftarrow G$ 
5:   for every pair  $\{g_i, g_j\}$ ,  $g_i \neq g_j$  in  $\hat{G}$  do
6:      $r \leftarrow \overline{S(g_i, g_j)}^{\hat{G}}$ 
7:     if  $r \neq 0$  then
8:        $G \leftarrow G \cup \{r\}$ 
9:     end if
10:  end for
11: end while
12: return  $G$ 
```

at every point of the algorithm. Since we are solely using functions that generate I , any remainder from division will be on I as well. So by extending G with the remainder, $G \subseteq I$ holds. The fact that the ideal G is a Gröbner basis comes from theorem 3.12. The algorithm terminates when $\overline{S(g_i, g_j)}^{\hat{G}} = 0$ for all pairs which was the condition for the basis to be a Gröbner basis.

The remaining part is to prove that the algorithm terminates. Consider the remainder, r , that is generated from the division of members on G . From lemma 3.2, we can note that the $LT(r)$ is not contained in $\hat{G}$, but is added to G . Thus, we can state that the $\langle LT(\hat{G}) \rangle \subseteq \langle LT(G) \rangle$ since $LT(r)$ is solely in $LT(G)$. Since we are dealing with an ascending chain of ideals in $k[x_1, \dots, x_n]$, the ascending chain condition can be used (see chapter 2.5 theorem 7 in [LM21]). By the ascending chain condition, there exists an $N \geq 1$ such that $I_N = I_{N+1} = I_{N+2} = \dots$. Thus, after N steps of the algorithm, further steps will not add any r , and the algorithm will terminate. $\square$

This algorithm was actually implemented *before* I properly understood Gröbner bases and S-polynomials. This is a fascinating aspect of the separation between proving algorithms and their implementations. Since mathematicians take great care in proving that the algorithm is correct, the implementer can trust the algorithm's correctness and tell the machine what to do. In a way, the person instructing the machine how to perform the tasks is a machine to the mathematician.

4.3 Solving Systems of Polynomials

The polynomial solution was by far the most involved algorithm to construct from a Macaulay2 standpoint. At this point, I was feeling much more comfortable with the language and started by following examples from the book [LM21], found under listing 5 and 6.

4.3.1 Book Examples of Polynomial Solutions

To start off, a simply single variable polynomial is considered. The quotient ring is generated, and the monomial basis is found. The implementation of this algorithm was done with as many built in functions that Macaulay2 has as possible, so most of the complexity is hidden. One important note, is that the "basis" function of Macaulay2 generates elements outside the ring, the "lift" function is used to bring them back into the ring. Consider the fact that $\frac{4}{2}$ can be "lifted" from $\mathbb{Q}$ to $\mathbb{Z}$. After this, we find the Q matrix associated with Z , or M_z^Q . The first step is to find the quotient of the ring by the ideal and then find the basis of the quotient. Then, loop over the basis and find the modulo of the basis times the polynomial by the ideal. The remainder of this operation will contain coefficients that correspond to the basis. These coefficients are extracted and put into a matrix.

Algorithm 4 SolveQMatrix

Require: A ring, R , a zero-dimensional ideal, I , and the polynomial to evaluate p .

Ensure: The matrix, M_p^Q .

```
1:  $q \leftarrow R/I$ 
2:  $b_1, \dots, b_n \leftarrow \text{basis } q$ 
3:  $\text{rows} \leftarrow \{\}$ 
4: for  $b_i$  in  $b_1, \dots, b_n$  do
5:    $r \leftarrow (p \cdot b_i) \bmod I$ 
6:    $\text{rows} \leftarrow \text{rows} \cup \{\text{coefficients}(r) \text{ from } b_1, \dots, b_n\}$ 
7: end for
8:  $M \leftarrow \text{matrix}(\text{rows})$ 
9: return  $M$ 
```

The second book example, listing 6 complicates things slightly by introducing a second variable. However, at this point I realized that a dedicated function to solving M^Q would be necessary. All that needed to be done was to extract the logic used in listing 5 and refactored it to its own function, see algorithm 4. After testing to ensure that they returned the same result, implementing the second example was

easier. Solving the M^Q is as easy as sending the ring, ideal, and the monomial of interest for the matrix. Solving the eigenvalues uses the built in functionality, so matching the books solution was no problem.

Again, at this point of the algorithm implementation, I had read the book and familiarized myself with all relevant concepts. But I did not truly understand everything, simply enough to implement the algorithm.

4.3.2 Solving a System of Polynomial Equations

Algorithm 5 Solution of a system of polynomial equations

Require: A non-zero, zero-dimensional ideal, $I = \langle p_1, \dots, p_s \rangle$ in $\mathbb{R}[x_1, \dots, x_n]$

Ensure: The points in $\mathbf{V}_{\mathbb{C}}(I)$

```

1:  $q \leftarrow \mathbb{R}[x_1, \dots, x_n]/I$ 
2:  $b_1, \dots, b_l \leftarrow$  basis  $q$ 
3:  $\text{eigenList} \leftarrow \{\}$ 
4: for  $i = 1$  to  $n$  do
5:    $Q \leftarrow \text{solveQMatrix}(R, I, x_i)$ 
6:    $\text{eigenList} \leftarrow \text{eigenList} \cup \text{eigenvalues of } Q.$ 
7: end for
8: Compute the sets:
9:    $X_{\mathbb{R}} = \{\hat{x} \in \mathbb{R}^n : \hat{x}_i \in \text{eigenList}_i, i = 1, \dots, n \text{ and } p_j(\hat{x}) = 0, j = 1, \dots, s\}$ 
10:   $X_{\mathbb{C}} = \{\hat{x} \in \mathbb{C}^n : \hat{x}_i \in \text{eigenList}_i, i = 1, \dots, n \text{ and } p_j(\hat{x}) = 0, j = 1, \dots, s\}$ 
11: return  $\mathbf{V}_{\mathbb{C}}(I) = X_{\mathbb{C}}$  and  $\mathbf{V}_{\mathbb{R}}(I) = X_{\mathbb{R}}$ 
```

The book [LM21] gives an algorithm to solve the points in a variety . Equipped with the function to solve M^Q , it should have been easy. Starting off, for a ring $R[x_1, \dots, x_n]$, all the $M_{x_i}^Q$ had to be found. This was easy enough, and finding the eigenvalues thereafter was also something previously done in the book exercises. However, the difficult part came when calculating the sets or, constructing the candidate points to plug back into the initial functions. Using "fold", which constructs a composite function, and "table", which takes two lists and creates all possible pairs with those two lists. These in conjunction create all possible sets of the eigenlists. However, when the function evaluates the candidate points over the ideal, to see which yield 0, a slight problem occurs. The exact cause is unknown, but since the ring is in $\mathbb{R}$, the computations are not exact and slight variations can cause duplication to occur. In order to solve this issue, there is additional code that filters almost duplicate solutions. This filter works by ensuring that the sum of the distance between all the points is lesser than a defined epsilon.

5 Discussion

There are two distinct parts of this thesis to consider: the construction of an algorithm and the execution of an algorithm. They were not weighed equally in this thesis. This section considers the imbalance between the two and what they offered as part of a thesis surrounding mathematics.

5.1 Mathematical Proof and Knowledge

Building an algorithm requires intimate knowledge of underlying mathematical concepts as well as a familiarity with proof construction. While background knowledge was gathered for affine varieties, and more generally algebraic geometry, these were less significant to the scope of the thesis. Instead, these concepts justified the exploration of Gröbner bases. Even then, theory surrounding the *usage* of Gröbner bases was limited. Instead, a majority of the theoretical knowledge and proofs found in the thesis concern Gröbner bases, specifically the construction of the Buchberger criterion. The criterion is the motor behind the Buchberger algorithm, used to construct Gröbner bases, and provided deep insight into how algorithms are created.

Singling in on the Buchberger criterion left other parts of the mathematical domain unexplored. Especially when it comes to the Gröbner bases usefulness. The elimination properties of the bases and any application to algebraic geometry or robotics were left unexplored. Both the topics are interesting in their own regard, and future work surrounding the subject would do well to engage with them in greater detail.

5.2 Algorithm Implementation

The traditional mathematical method of proving theorems was less important in the creation of this thesis. Instead the primary focus was directed towards the implementation of algorithms. While an impressive part of algorithms is transforming an idea to something concrete, another is to implement the algorithm itself. For a bachelors thesis, the implementation felt appropriate. Familiarizing oneself with the process of algorithm construction was of importance but exploring the implementation was more fruitful from a learning aspect. Abstract algebra can be confusing, and having concretizing concepts so a machine can execute the algorithm increased understanding of the underlying objects. Learning a computer language

where ideals are an integral reason to its creation is bound to provide deeper insight into ideals themselves. To use ideals and rings, one must have a working knowledge of them.

Through implementation, the balancing act between the amount of work that is necessary to create these algorithms and keeping the implementation simple can be appreciated. The Buchberger algorithm is reduced to concrete steps, such as finding S-polynomials 3.9, but proving that the Buchberger criterion is sufficient for Gröbner basis is involved. In contrast, the algorithm that finds the solution to polynomial systems (listing 4) provides guidelines and is flexible in its interpretation; it shifts more responsibility to the implementee.

A Macaulay2 source files

A link to all the source files can be found at the github link [\[Eri26\]](#) under the m2 folder.

A.1 Algorithms

Listing 1: A Univariate Division Algorithm

```
1 univariatePolynomialDivision = (p,g) -> (  
2   q := 0;  
3   r := p;  
4   while (r != 0_R and degree(g) < degree(r)) do (  
5     t := leadTerm(r) / leadTerm(g);  
6     q = q+t;  
7     r = r-t*g;  
8   );  
9   (q,r)  
10  )  
11  
12 runUnivariateTest = () -> (  
13   R = QQ[x];  
14   p := x^6 - 1;  
15   g := x^4 - 1;  
16  
17   (resultQ, resultR) := univariatePolynomialDivision(p,g);  
18  
19   print(resultQ == x^2);  
20   print(resultR == x^2 - 1);  
21 )
```

The multivariate division algorithm is loaded into other scripts under the alias `algorithm123.m2`. This is due to the fact that the pseudocode found as algorithm 1.2.3 [\[LM21\]](#). `LeadingTermDivision` is a failed attempted at dividing the leading terms, but is kept to display progress.

Listing 2: The Multivariate Division Algorithm.

```
1 multivariatePolynomialDivision = (p, gs) -> (  
2   r := 0_(ring p);  
3   f := p;  
4   qs := for i from 0 to #gs-1 list 0_(ring p); --generating  
        dummy variable for result
```

```

5
6   while f != 0_(ring p) do (
7       i := 0;
8       divisionOccured := false;
9       --print "Outer loop";
10
11      while (i < #gs and divisionOccured == false) do (
12          --print "Inner loop";
13          lmf := leadMonomial f;
14          lmg := leadMonomial (gs#i);
15
16          if (lmf % lmg == 0) then (
17              monomialQuotient := lmf // lmg;
18
19              coefficientQuotient := leadCoefficient f /
20                  leadCoefficient gs#i;
21
22              t := coefficientQuotient * monomialQuotient;
23
24              qs = replace(i, qs#i + t, qs);
25              f = f - t*gs#i;
26
27              divisionOccured = true;
28              --print "we were divisible";
29          )
30          else (
31              i = i+1;
32
33              --print "not divisible, function further along";
34          )
35      );
36
37      if divisionOccured == false then (
38          r = r + leadTerm(f);
39          f = f - leadTerm(f);
40          --print "division did not occur, subtracting leading
41              term and continuing";
42      );
43  );
44  return (qs, r)

```



```

45 -- This below code is useless, it was an attempt to get around the
    fact that i couldnt divide with the leadTerm.
46 -- However, I needed to seperate out the divisions as well as use
    "/" instead of "/"
47 leadingTermDevison = (p,g) -> (
48     lmP := leadMonomial(p);
49     lmG := leadMonomial(g);
50     lcP := leadCoefficient(p);
51     lcG := leadCoefficient(g);
52     exponentsP := flatten exponents lmP;
53     exponentsG := flatten exponents lmG;
54
55     divisible := all(#exponentsP, i -> exponentsP#i >=
        exponentsG#i); --checking that all exponents are greater or
        equal
56     result := 0_(ring p);
57
58     if divisible then(
59         coefficientResult := lcP / lcG;
60
61         exponentsQ := for i from 0 to (#exponentsP-1) list
            (exponentsP#i - exponentsG#i); --doing the division
62
63         ringVariables := toList gens ring p;
64
65         Q := product(#ringVariables, i -> ringVariables#i ^
            (exponentsQ#i)); --generating the the polynomial
66
67         result = coefficientResult * Q;
68     );
69
70     return (divisible, result);
71 )
72
73 runMultimultivariateTest = () -> (
74     R = QQ[x,y,MonomialOrder=>Lex];
75     p := -x^2*y-x^2+x*y+y^3;
76     g1 := x*y-x+y-1;
77     g2 := x+y+1;
78
79     (resultG1, resultRemainder1) :=
        multivariatePolynomialDivision(p,{g1,g2});

```

```

80     (resultG2, resultRemainder2) :=
      multivariatePolynomialDivision(p,{g2,g1});
81
82     print "-----{g1,g2}-----";
83     print resultG1;
84     print resultRemainder1;
85     print (resultG1#0 == -x+4);
86     print (resultG1#1 == -2*x+5);
87     print (resultRemainder1 == y^3-9*y-1);
88
89     print "-----{g2,g1}-----";
90     print resultG2;
91     print resultRemainder2;
92     print (resultG2#1 == 0);
93     print (resultG2#0 == -x*y-x+y^2+3*y+1);
94     print (resultRemainder2 == -4*y^2-4*y-1);
95 )

```

The Buchberger algorithm is used to find Gröbner bases. The function FindXDelta was later replaced with the native least common denominator function to reduce clutter and error.

Listing 3: Buchbergers Algorithm.

```

1  load "algorithm123.m2";
2
3  buchberger = ps -> (
4      g := ps;
5      gHat := {0_(ring ps#0)};
6
7      while g != gHat do (
8          gHat = g;
9
10         -- generating all the possible pairs by looping through i
           and then from j -> end
11         polynomialPairs := flatten for i from 0 to #gHat-1 list
           for j from i+1 to #gHat-1 list (gHat#i, gHat#j);
12
13         i := 0;
14         while i < #polynomialPairs do (
15             p := (polynomialPairs#i)#0;
16             q := (polynomialPairs#i)#1;
17

```

```

18         xDelta := lcm(leadMonomial(p), leadMonomial(q));
19
20         s := xDelta // leadTerm(p) * p - xDelta // leadTerm(q)
           * q;
21
22         (qs, r) = multivariatePolynomialDivision(s, gHat);
23
24         if r != 0_(ring ps#0) then (
25             g = append(gHat, r);
26         );
27
28         i = i+1;
29     );
30 );
31 print g;
32 return g;
33 )
34
35 testAlgorithm = () -> (
36     R = QQ[x,y, MonomialOrder => GLex];
37
38     p1 := x^2 + y;
39     p2 := x^4 + 2*x^2*y + y^2 + 3;
40
41     myBasis := gb ideal (buchberger({p1, p2}));
42     correctBasis := gb ideal(p1, p2);
43     areTheyEqual := myBasis == correctBasis;
44
45     print "My basis:";
46     print myBasis;
47
48     print "Built-in basis:";
49     print gens correctBasis;
50
51     print "Are they equal?";
52     print areTheyEqual;
53 )
54
55 --again, this is not needed and M2 implements LCM.
56 findXDelta = (p,q) -> (
57     alpha := flatten exponents leadMonomial(p);
58     gamma := flatten exponents leadMonomial(q);

```

```

59
60   delta := for i from 0 to (#alpha-1) list
        (max(alpha#i,gamma#i)); --getting the max of each variables
        exponent
61
62   ringVariables := toList gens ring p;
63   xDelta := product(#ringVariables, i -> ringVariables#i ^
        (delta#i)); -- reconstructing the variable
64
65   return xDelta
66 )
67
68 testGamma = () -> (
69   R := RR[x,y, MonomialOrder => GLex];
70   p := x^3*y^2-x^2*y^3+x;
71   q := 3*x^4*y +y^2;
72
73   xDelta := findXDelta(p,q);
74   xDeltaShouldBe := x^4*y^2;
75
76   print "-----gamma results-----";
77   print xDelta;
78   print xDeltaShouldBe;
79   print("the result is " | toString(xDelta == xDeltaShouldBe))
80 )

```

Referred to as algorithm 1.6.1 as the pseudocode we found under the same name in [LM21]. The refactored QMatrix function can be found here, but was initially created using the preparatory examples listing 5 and listing 5.

Listing 4: Solution to Systes of Polynomial Equations

```

1 solveSystemOfPolynomialEquations = (theRing, theIdeal) -> (
2   varsToLoopOver := gens theRing;
3
4   -- get the list of eigenvalues
5   eigenList := for var in varsToLoopOver list (
6     qMatrix := solveQMatrix(theRing, theIdeal, var);
7
8     --ensure that the eigenvector can be solved and save it
      to the list
9     toList eigenvalues(sub(qMatrix,CC))
10  );

```

```

11
12      -- use fold to go through all elements in the eigenList
      outwards
13  candidatePoints := fold((L1, L2) -> (
14      --use table to create a table of all the pairs and
      flatten down
15      flatten table(L1, L2, (a, b) -> (
16          --if we are past first instance, we append
          instead of create a list
17          if instance(a, List) then a | {b} else {a, b}
18      )
19      )
20      ),
21      eigenList);
22
23  epsilon := 1e-6;
24  functionList := flatten entries gens theIdeal;
25
26  validSolutions := select(candidatePoints, pt -> (
27      -- ensure that x_n maps to the the nth point
28      subMap = apply(#varsToLoopOver, i -> varsToLoopOver#i
29          => pt#i);
30      -- sub in the values
31      all(functionList, p -> abs(sub(p, subMap)) < epsilon)
32      ));
33
34      -- something is wrong with my solveQMatrix which results in
      cluttered returns.
35
36      -- so for now just to check if it works, we remove the
      duplicates
37  uniqueSolutions := {};
38  scan(validSolutions, v -> (
39      if not any(uniqueSolutions, u -> (
40          dist := sqrt(sum(0..#v-1, i -> abs(v#i -
41              u#i)^2));
42          dist < epsilon
43          )) then uniqueSolutions =
44          append(uniqueSolutions, v);
45      ));
46
47  uniqueSolutions
48  )

```

```

45
46
47 testAlgorithm2D = () -> (
48     R := CC[x, y];
49     I := ideal(x^2 + y^2 - 5, x*y - 2);
50
51     myResults := solveSystemOfPolynomialEquations(R, I);
52     solution := {{-2, -1}, {-1, -2}, {2, 1}, {1, 2}};
53
54     print ("The 2D test output: " | toString myResults);
55
56     print ("Verified solution: " | toString solution);
57 )
58
59 testAlgorithm4D = () -> (
60     R4 := CC[x1, x2, x3, x4];
61
62     p1 := x1^2 + x2^2 - 2;
63     p2 := x1 - x2;
64     p3 := x3^2 + x4^2 - 13;
65     p4 := x3*x4 - 6;
66     I4 := ideal(p1, p2, p3, p4);
67
68     results4D := solveSystemOfPolynomialEquations(R4, I4);
69
70     if #results4D == 8 then (
71         print "SUCCESS: Found all 8 points in 4D space.";
72     ) else (
73         print ("FAILURE: Expected 8 points, but found " |
74             #results4D);
75     );
76 )
77
78 solveQMatrix = (theRing, theIdeal, thePolynomial) ->(
79     q := theRing / theIdeal;
80
81     basisList := flatten entries basis q;
82     polyBasis := for b in basisList list lift(b,theRing); --basis
83         to R
84
85     rows := for b in polyBasis list (
86         currentPoly := thePolynomial * b;

```

```

85         r := currentPoly % theIdeal;
86
87         coeffsMatrix := last coefficients(r, Monomials =>
88             polyBasis);
89         flatten entries coeffsMatrix
90     );
91     return transpose matrix rows;
92 )
93
94 print "-----2D CASE-----";
95 testAlgorithm2D();
96 print "-----4D CASE-----";
97 testAlgorithm4D();
98 print "-----DONE-----";

```

A.2 Examples

Listing 5: Example 1.6.12 [LM21]

```
1 runExample = () -> (  
2   R = RR[z];  
3  
4   g := z^3-3*z^2+2*z;  
5  
6   I = ideal g;  
7  
8   q := R / I;  
9  
10  basisList := flatten entries basis q;  
11  polyBasis := for b in basisList list lift(b, R); -- ensuring  
12              that the actualy polynomials exists in R and not only in q  
13  
14  rows := for b in basisList list (  
15      currentPoly = z *lift(b,R);  
16  
17      r := currentPoly % I;  
18  
19      --taking #1 here since coefficients returns a bundle of  
20      want the coefficients, no the monomials  
21      coeffsMatrix := (coefficients(r, Monomials =>  
22          polyBasis))#1;  
23      flatten entries coeffsMatrix  
24  );  
25  
26  zmatrix := matrix rows;  
27  
28  finalZMatrix := zmatrix^2+zmatrix+id_(target zmatrix);  
29  return finalZMatrix;  
30 )  
31  
32 runExampleWithFunction = () -> (  
33   R = RR[z];  
34  
35   g := z^3-3*z^2+2*z;  
36  
37   I = ideal g;
```



```

37     load "algorithm161.m2";
38
39     zmatrix := solveQMatrix(R, I, z);
40
41     finalZMatrix := zmatrix^2+zmatrix+id_(target zmatrix);
42     return finalZMatrix;
43 )
44
45 testFunction = () -> (
46     preBuiltMatrix := runExample();
47     matrixFromFunction := runExampleWithFunction();
48
49     print "Matrix from the example";
50     print preBuiltMatrix;
51
52     print "Matrix using refactored function";
53     print matrixFromFunction;
54 )

```

Listing 6: Example 1.6.13 [LM21]

```

1  runExample = () -> (
2      load "algorithm161.m2";
3
4      R = RR[x,y];
5      f := (y^2+x-3, x^2-4*x*y-y^2-10*y+15);
6      I := ideal f;
7
8      regMatrix := solveQMatrix(R,I,1);
9      xMatrix := solveQMatrix(R,I,x);
10     xyMatrix := solveQMatrix(R,I,x*y);
11     yMatrix := solveQMatrix(R,I,y);
12
13     --only care about the x,y individual ones
14     xEigens := (eigenvectors sub(xMatrix,CC))#0;
15     yEigens := (eigenvectors sub(yMatrix,CC))#0;
16
17     varietyList := for i from 0 to #xEigens-1 list {xEigens#i,
18         yEigens#i};
19     print varietyList;
20 )

```

Listing 7: Macaulay2 code from 2.1.1 [LM21]

```

1 R = QQ[x_1..x_4, MonomialOrder => Lex]
2
3 p1 = x_1-x_2**2+x_3
4
5 p2 = x_1**2+x_2*x_3**2+x_4
6
7 I = ideal(p1,p2)
8
9 G = gens gb I
10
11 polyToDivide = x_1**2+x_2**2+x_3**2+x_4**2-1
12
13 rem = polyToDivide%I
14
15 print("the rem is: ")
16 print(rem)

```

Listing 8: Macaulay2 code from 2.2.1 [\[LM21\]](#)

```

1 R = QQ[x_1,x_2,x_3]
2
3 p = (1/2)+x_1^2*x_2*x_3^4+(6/5)*x_1*x_3+2
4
5 -- output is a polynomial in R

```

Listing 9: Macaulay2 code from 2.2.2 [\[LM21\]](#)

```

1 R = frac(QQ[a]/ideal(a^2-2))[x_1,x_2,x_3]
2
3 substitute(a^2, R)
4 -- output is that a^2 = 2
5
6 p = x_1 + x_2 + a*x_3

```

Listing 10: Macaulay2 code from 2.3.1 [\[LM21\]](#)

```

1 R = QQ[z]
2
3 p = z^4+3*z^3-3*z^2+3*z-4
4
5 pc = -2*z^4+3*z^3-6*z^2+5*z-4
6
7 g = z^2+1

```

```

8
9 (q,r)= quotientRemainder(p,g)
10
11 (qc, rc) = quotientRemainder(pc,g)

```

Listing 11: Macaulay2 code from 2.3.2 [LM21]

```

1 R=QQ[c_1,c_2,c_3,c_4, MonomialOrder=>Lex]
2 M = matrix{{1,-2,0,-1},{4,0,7,3}, {7,-6,7,0}}
3 C = matrix{{c_1},{c_2},{c_3},{c_4}}
4 I = ideal(M*C)
5 GI = value toString gens gb I
6 (Ce,Me) = value toString coefficients(GI,
    Monomials=>{c_1,c_2,c_3,c_4})
7
8 Mr = value toString transpose Me
9
10 --powerful way to solve the row reduced form
11 inverse(substitute(submatrix(Mr, {0,1}),QQ))*Mr

```

Listing 12: documentationConditionals.m2 [GS]

```

1 isEven = i -> i % 2 == 0
2
3 oddOrEven = i -> (
4     if isEven i then "even"
5     else "odd")

```


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